

HSE TOOLBOX TALK

FORKLIFT SAFETY

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Review forklift hazards including overturning, collisions, dropped loads, blind spots and pedestrian safety while applying safe operating practices. Only trained and authorised operators may operate forklifts. Complete daily inspections before use.

KEY HAZARDS

1



PEDESTRIAN STRIKE

2



TIP-OVER

3



DROPPED LOAD

4



BLIND SPOT

5



OVERLOAD

6



RAMP

7



DAMAGED PALLET

8



UNAUTHORIZED DRIVING

CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

100%

Authorized and evaluated operator

0

Pedestrians in active operating zone

Within capacity

Load and attachment verification



REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA 1910.178 establishes operator training and evaluation, daily inspection, safe travel, loading and maintenance requirements.

OSHA 1910.178(l)

OPERATOR TRAINING

Train the operator on truck and workplace topics, evaluate practical performance and authorize operation.

OSHA 1910.178(m)

TRAVELLING

Yield to pedestrians, travel at a safe speed, reverse when the load blocks view and keep forks low.

OSHA 1910.178(o)

LOADING

Handle only stable loads within capacity; center and tilt the load and do not travel with it elevated.

OSHA 1910.178(q)

MAINTENANCE

Remove unsafe trucks from service and have repairs completed by authorized personnel using suitable parts.

MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Operator authorization and evaluation | ☐ Pre-shift inspection form |
| ☐ Capacity plate / attachment data | ☐ Traffic and pedestrian route plan |
| ☐ Load / pallet condition check | ☐ Maintenance and defect record |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- Has the daily inspection been completed?
- Is the operator authorised?
- Is visibility restricted?

PEDESTRIAN-FORKLIFT SEPARATION AND CONTROLLED ROUTE



Separated route - Low speed - Visibility - Stable load - Spotter - Seat belt

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. SEPARATE PEOPLE AND FORKLIFTS

Complete the daily inspection. Use authorised operators only.

2. CONTROL ROUTE, SPEED AND VISIBILITY

Wear the seat belt. Carry loads low. Use reverse travel or a spotter if visibility is blocked.

3. VERIFY TRUCK AND LOAD

Follow pedestrian controls. Obey speed limits. Lower forks before parking.

4. PARK SAFELY

Apply the parking brake. Remove defective forklifts from service.

CRITICAL WARNING



A forklift is a material handling vehicle, not a personnel carrier.

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Authorised operator | ☐ Inspection complete |
| ☐ Brakes OK | ☐ Horn working |
| ☐ Alarm working | ☐ Forks OK |
| ☐ Load secure | ☐ Seat belt worn |
| ☐ Pedestrian routes clear | |

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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site:

Date:

Presented by:

Work area:

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			